
Ann Atwater

annatwater@ufl.edu

annatwater.com

Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Economics of Education, Applied Microeconomics

Education

University of Florida

Ph.D. in Economics, 2026

M.A. in Economics, 2022

B.S. in Mathematics, *Cum Laude* 2020

B.S. in Statistics, *Cum Laude* 2020

B.A. in Economics, *Summa Cum Laude* 2020

Published Research

“The Quality of Online Instruction and Returns to Instructor Experience”

(with Xi Zhang)

Economics of Education Review, 2025

“Does Online Testing Make the Grade? Evidence from a Randomized Controlled Trial”

(Corresponding Author, with Mark Rush and Perihan Saygin)

Education Finance and Policy, 2025

“Gender Differences in Leaving Questions Blank on High-Stakes Standardized Tests”

(with Perihan Saygin)

Economics of Education Review, 2021

Working Papers

“Distributional Effects of Mergers: Evidence from Low-Cost Carriers”

(Job Market Paper, [Available on SSRN](#))

Research in Progress

“Airline Mergers and the Reallocation of Productive Assets”

“Whose Experience Matters? Returns During the COVID-19 Shock”

(With Xi Zhang)

Instructional Experience

As Instructor:

Intermediate Microeconomics, University of Florida
Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026

As Teaching Assistant:

Principles of Macroeconomics, Principles of Microeconomics,
Economic Analysis of Data, Intermediate Microeconomics

Employment

August 2023 – April 2026	Graduate Instructor, University of Florida
August 2020 – April 2023	Graduate Assistant, University of Florida
June 2019 – August 2019	Summer Analyst, Federal Reserve Bank of New York
May 2018 – May 2020	Undergraduate Research Assistant, University of Florida
May 2017 – May 2020	Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, University of Florida

Seminars and Conferences

November 2025	Southern Economic Association Conference 95 th Annual Meeting
November 2025	City University of New York Higher Education Research Seminar Series
October 2025	2025 Workshop in Applied and Theoretical Economics
November 2024	Southern Economic Association Conference 94 th Annual Meeting

Skills

<u>Computer:</u>	<u>Proficient:</u> R, LaTeX, SQL <u>Experienced:</u> Stata, Git, Microsoft Excel, High-Performance Computing <u>Familiar:</u> Python (numpy, pandas, transformers, pyblp), ArcGIS, MATLAB
<u>Statistics:</u>	Causal Inference, Demand Estimation (Structural), Experimental Design, Sampling, Survey Design, Data Analysis, Natural Language Processing, Instrumental Variables, Panel Data Methods, Merger Simulation, Propensity Score Matching, Kernel Matching, Mahalanobis Distance Matching, Logit Regression
<u>Languages:</u>	English (Native), Japanese (Business Level, N2)

Awards and Accolades

2025	Madelyn Lockhart Graduate Student Travel Award University of Florida Department of Economics
2024	Madelyn Lockhart Graduate Student Travel Award University of Florida Department of Economics
2021	Rafael Lusky Prize – Best First Year Graduate Student University of Florida Department of Economics

Certifications

2025	Japanese Language Proficiency Test N2
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Professional References

Ignacia Mercadal imercadal@ufl.edu (Doctoral Committee Chair)	Assistant Professor Department of Economics University of Florida Gainesville, Florida, United States
Perihan Saygin peri.saygin@uab.cat (Former Committee Chair)	Assistant Professor Department of Applied Economics Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona Bellaterra, Cerdanyola del Vallés, Spain
Douglas Turner douglasterner@ufl.edu (Doctoral Committee Member)	Assistant Professor Department of Economics University of Florida Gainesville, Florida, United States